

3.1 Techniques to test/check and review interactive digital media

Techniques to test/check the technical properties of interactive digital media

- Methods of testing and checking
 - test plan
 - checklist
 - success criteria
- Elements of interactive media to test/check
 - testing input or behaviours
 - trying to break inputs
 - testing by following navigation paths or by deliberately not
 - functionality tests
 - navigation
 - interactivity
 - inputs and outputs

Performance of multimedia assets

- testing multimedia functions
 - testing playback/appearance
 - testing volume/quality
 - testing user controls for multimedia

Techniques to review the fitness for purpose of completed interactive digital media

- Suitability for client requirements
- Suitability for target audience
 - suitability of content
 - accessibility
- Review of audio-visual quality, aesthetics, appeal, interaction, and engagement

To include:

- The structure, content and use of test plans, checklist and success criteria
- How to record test results and how and when to retest
- How and why to test iteratively both during production post-production
- Planning and carrying out a range of functionality tests to make sure interactive digital media products function as intended
- Checking the component quality of interactive digital media products
- Checking the suitability of file formats used for interactive digital media against lists of compatible formats with the intended platforms, devices or distribution channels

Does not include:

- Peer or client testing/focus group feedback
- Performance tuning and debugging, black and white box testing, soak testing, load testing, regression testing

To include:

- Strengths and weaknesses of created interactive digital media
- Comparing created interactive digital media products against client briefs, client requirement lists or success criteria
- Assessing the appropriateness of chosen styles and approaches/conventions for clients and target audiences
- Assessing fitness for purpose e.g. adverts should advertise; promotions should promote

Does not include:

- Client/peer/focus group feedback or review, questionnaires, vox pop

Unit R097: Interactive digital media

3.2 Improvements and further developments

Constraints which limit the effectiveness of interactive digital media

- Interactive digital media constraints
 - time
 - resources
 - hardware
 - software
 - skills
- Interactive digital media improvements
 - overall style and design
 - quality
 - content and concept
 - animation/video
 - audio

Further development opportunities for digital media

- Further developments
 - scope
 - additional multimedia elements
 - more or different interactivity
 - altering product type

To include:

- How the quality of created interactive digital media products are constrained by time, resources, hardware, software, budget, legislation, skills
- The feasible improvements to created interactive digital media products in terms of client requirements and target audience engagement

To include:

- How successful interactive digital media products can lead to repeat business/further commissions from a client
- How different resources, software, budget and skills could help interactive digital media to be developed further
- How to devise further developments in terms of client requirements and target audience

Marking criteria

[Section 6.4](#) provides full information on how to mark the NEA units and apply the marking criteria. The marking criteria descriptor words are further explained in [Appendix B](#).

The tables below contain the marking criteria for the tasks for this unit. If a student's work does not meet any Mark Band 1 (MB1) criteria for the task, you must award zero marks for that task.

Unit R097 – Topic Area 1: Plan interactive digital media		
MB1: 1–2 marks	MB2: 3–4 marks	MB3: 5–6 marks
Produces a basic interpretation of the client brief. Explanation of how the intended product meets the client brief and why it appeals to the target audience is limited .	Produces an adequate interpretation of the client brief. Explanation of how the intended product meets the client brief and why it appeals to the target audience is sound .	Produces an effective interpretation of the client brief. Explanation of how the intended product meets the client brief and why it appeals to the target audience is comprehensive .
MB1: 1–3 marks	MB2: 4–6 marks	MB3: 7–8 marks
Produces basic pre-production and planning documentation. Pre-production and planning documentation support the creation of few elements of the final product.	Produces adequate pre-production and planning documentation. Pre-production and planning documentation support the creation of some elements of the final product.	Produces detailed pre-production and planning documentation. Pre-production and planning documentation support the creation of all elements of the final product.
MB1: 1–2 marks	MB2: 3–4 marks	MB3: 5–6 marks
Demonstrates limited understanding of how assets will contribute to the effectiveness of the final product.	Demonstrates sound understanding of how assets will contribute to the effectiveness of the final product.	Demonstrates comprehensive understanding of how assets will contribute to the effectiveness of the final product.

MB1: 1–4 marks	MB2: 5–8 marks	MB3: 9–12 marks
Use of technical skills to create the component parts is limited in its effectiveness. Conventions and creativity in the components are limited in their fitness for purpose. The range of components supports the creation of the final product in a limited way.	Use of technical skills to create the component parts is partly effective. Conventions and creativity in the components are adequate in their fitness for purpose. The range of components partly supports the creation of the final product.	Use of technical skills to create the component parts is effective. Conventions and creativity in the components are fully fit for purpose. The range of components fully supports the creation of the final product.
MB1: 1–5 marks	MB2: 6–10 marks	MB3: 11–14 marks
Use of technical skills to create the final product is limited in its effectiveness. Conventions and creativity are applied in the final product in a limited way. Final product is limited in its fitness for purpose.	Use of technical skills to create the final product is partly effective. Conventions and creativity are adequately applied in the final product. Final product is adequately fit for purpose.	Use of technical skills to create the final product is effective. Conventions and creativity are effectively applied in the final product. Final product is fully fit for purpose.
MB1: 1–3 marks	MB2: 4–6 marks	MB3: 7–8 marks
Formats of the saved/exported components are limited in their appropriateness. Properties and format(s) of the final product are limited in their appropriateness.	Formats of the saved/exported components are adequate in their appropriateness. Properties and format(s) of the final product are adequate in their appropriateness.	Formats of the saved/exported components are clearly appropriate. Properties and format(s) of the final product are clearly appropriate.

MB1: 1–3 marks	MB2: 4–7 marks	MB3: 8–10 marks
Testing/checking is limited in its effectiveness in reviewing technical properties. Review demonstrates limited understanding of the effectiveness of the final product for client and target audience.	Testing/checking is partly effective in reviewing technical properties. Review demonstrates sound understanding of the effectiveness of the final product for client and target audience.	Testing/checking is fully effective in reviewing technical properties. Review demonstrates critical understanding of the effectiveness of the final product for client and target audience.
MB1: 1–2 marks	MB2: 3–4 marks	MB3: 5–6 marks
Recommendations demonstrate limited understanding of areas for improvement and further development. Recommendations have limited explanation.	Recommendations demonstrate sound understanding of areas for improvement and further development. Recommendations are partly explained.	Recommendations demonstrate comprehensive understanding of areas for improvement and further development. Recommendations are fully explained.

Task 1

Strand 1a

For Mark Band (MB)1, students may have simply stated the chosen audience and restated the client. An explanation of the content or chosen style of the interactive digital media product with reference to the client brief would be more appropriate for MB2 or MB3. An explanation of only one or two ways in which the intended product meets the client brief and appeals to the target audience would be suitable for MB1. MB3 could be achieved by explaining a few ways in great detail (depth) or by explaining many ways concisely (breadth). Diagrammatic representations would illustrate the interpretation but would not be sufficient on their own to fulfil the requirement to explain for the upper two bands.

When interpreting the brief, students need to make decisions independently. Although it is to be expected that different students may make similar decisions and develop similar ideas, it would be highly unusual for all students in a cohort to have identical work.

Strand 1b

Pre-production documentation for the interactive digital media product could be presented in a number of different formats. Basic planning for MB1 may cover only the basic structure, layout and content of the product, whereas detailed planning for MB3 would be expected to include breadth and depth. Indicating how and where interactive digital media elements are combined and controlled would contribute meeting the upper MB criteria. It would be unlikely for any single pre-production document to cover 'all' elements of the final interactive digital media product. To meet the criteria for MB3, separate planning for different types of multimedia assets as well as planning for the final product itself would be expected.

Students must not be directed to complete specific planning tasks but may be referred to the teaching and learning content for the unit. When planning their interactive digital media product and justifying their design choices, students need to make decisions independently. Although it is to be expected that different students may make similar decisions and develop similar ideas, it would be highly unusual for all students in a cohort to have identical work.

Strand 1c

This strand requires students to demonstrate understanding of how assets contribute to the effectiveness of the interactive digital media product. A list of assets could be credited in MB1, but would not demonstrate understanding. A consideration of the technical properties of the assets chosen and reference to how the style or type of assets would appeal to the target audience or match the conventions of the type of interactive digital media product to be created would contribute to meeting the requirements for MB3.

Strand 2a

The component parts in this instance are the navigation elements and the multimedia assets. When creating the components, technical skills might be used to edit and prepare assets in suitable formats, sizes and quality. Demonstrating the skills and knowledge to create and repurpose assets to make sure they are technically suitable would be required to meet the criteria for MB3. Audio and video assets may be mixed and edited separately or together using a range of technical skills of appropriate software in order to meet the criteria for MB3. Fitness for purpose in terms of conventions used and creativity for MB3 could be credited if the multimedia components match the content stipulated in the client brief, and by adhering to the conventions of the product type requested. Where either the multimedia components or the final product is a poor match in terms of genre, content or design style a mark in the lower band would be suitable. Components support the creation of the final product by virtue of their range (different kinds of multimedia), and their properties. To fully support the creation of the final product for MB3, assets would need to be complete and technically fit for purpose. Few assets or types, or many assets but with limited technical suitability would be appropriately assessed in MB1.

Strand 2b

For MB1, the final product may be simplistic, incomplete or limited in its suitability as an interactive digital multimedia product. Some evidence of the tools used to create the product would support marks for this strand particularly if it is incomplete. Students might present screenshots to show the technical skills and tools of the software in use during the creation process. This is particularly helpful to credit some marks if the editing software is unavailable to assessors and the final product is not exported. An original idea which does not follow the conventions of an interactive digital media product would fit the criteria for MB1 in this strand for the conventions used and creativity. For credit in the upper mark bands both creativity and conventions should be evident in the final product. The criteria for fitness for purpose can be met by ensuring the final product is of a suitable, complexity, format and style and contains the content specified by the client. Typographical errors and omissions would limit fitness for purpose and so the mark for this descriptor would not be placed in the upper band.

When creating their interactive digital media product, students must make decisions independently. They must apply what they have learnt and not be led through a process to create an interactive digital media product. Students must not be directed to use particular software or software tools and/or techniques.

Strand 2c

This strand assesses the appropriateness of the components (the multimedia assets) and the final product (the interactive digital media product). In order to meet the criteria for MB3, the assets would need to be saved using appropriate formats and properties so that they can be incorporated in the final product. Choices of multimedia assets based on technical suitability and appropriateness of content would contribute to marks in the upper bands. Where the final product does not combine multimedia assets or is not exported to a suitable format to meet the brief, MB1 would be appropriate. For MB3, the naming of the final product file would contribute to demonstrate relevance to the client would be one way to make sure it is clearly appropriate. This criterion could also be supported by evidence that the file properties of the interactive digital media product are suitable for the output method or platform specified in the client brief.

When exporting their interactive digital media product, students need to independently decide on suitable electronic formats and properties.

Task 3

Students must produce their own review. They must apply what they have learnt and not be led through a process of reviewing their completed interactive digital media product.

Strand 3a

Review of the technical properties of the components and the finished interactive digital media product could be presented as a completed test plan. At MB1 this may only outline a few tests, or may be limited by testing only one or two components. If results and retests are considered this would contribute to MB2. An outline of how errors were resolved or prioritised for resolution might be expected at the upper end of the mark range. The components and product could be checked instead of or as well as testing. Evidence to support checking could include an account of how elements were watched or listened to, compared with the plans and designs and client brief and edited accordingly. To be effective for MB3, the technical properties of the components and product should be considered comprehensively.

The second descriptor assesses understanding of the effectiveness of the interactive digital media product for the client and target audience. If only the client or target audience are considered, a mark in MB1 may be suitable. For the upper mark band both client and target audience, and the multimedia components and final product should be considered. A test plan on its own would not evidence understanding of effectiveness, only functionality; so, some form of account or explanation would be expected for the upper mark bands.

Strand 3b

This strand requires an understanding of areas for improvement and further development, and an explanation of the recommendations. A list of aspects which failed when testing the interactive digital media product would demonstrate limited understanding for MB1. For MB3 students may have prioritised aspects to be addressed. Explaining which are the most important and why might be one way to demonstrate comprehensive understanding. Areas for improvement and further development should be explained with reference to the client requirements and target audience engagement in order to demonstrate comprehensive understanding for MB3, and should include both the component parts of the product and the interactive digital media product itself. If only the components or the interactive digital media product are considered, a mark in MB1 would be suitable. Since there is no requirement for a prescribed number of improvements and developments, a few aspects considered and explained in detail could nevertheless meet the criteria for MB3.

Topic Area		Topic Area	
1	Plan interactive digital media	2	Factors influencing product design
		3	Pre-production planning
		4	Distribution considerations
2	Create interactive digital media	3	Pre-production planning
		4	Distribution considerations
3	Review interactive digital media	2	Factors influencing product design
		3	Pre-production planning
		4	Distribution considerations

More information about synoptic assessment within this qualification can be found in [section 5.2 Synoptic assessment](#).